

TveeBoX Allows Computing and Communications on TV

Bengaluru-based NextBit Computing has built a set-top box named TveeBoX that brings triple-play features of entertainment, communication and computing to a single device—the television

■ VANISHA JOSEPH

Matrimony between the television and the Internet—that is what TveeBoX, an over-the-top set-top box (OTT STB) developed by Bengaluru-based NextBit Computing, has achieved. Watching movies from your USB, browsing the Internet, streaming live from YouTube, connecting to a hosted cloud computing service, digital TV and videoconferencing, the TveeBoX allows you to do it all from your TV.

The TveeBoX features a LAN interface, with which the STB can be connected to the Internet. It also features support for USB wireless broadband modems provided by major Indian telecom Internet service providers (ISPs). With these modes of Internet connectivity, the TveeBoX when connected to a TV, using RCA, VGA or HDMI connectivity, allows the user to access Internet content formatted for the TV screen. It is compatible with 2G, 3G, HSDPA, EVDO and upcoming technologies like WiMax and LTE. The device features an ARM9 core running at sub-300 MHz, and presents itself in two models, basic and high end, with differentiated features and application capabilities.

Transforming the idiot box into an infotainment package

So what makes TveeBoX a cut above other STBs in the market? The triple-play features of entertainment, com-



TveeBoX over-the-top set-top box (OTT STB)

munication and computing in a single box, enhanced user experience, power efficiency, low bandwidth requirements and low cost make TveeBoX truly sensational.

All-in-one STB. The TveeBoX is one of the first STB platforms to be truly convergent. It brings capabilities of computing, communication and social media to a device that is available in every household in India—the humble idiot box. The user can access browser, cloud PC, YouTube, Facebook, Bittorrent, Twitter, Flickr and many more applications directly on his TV screen. Most STBs do not allow cloud computing and video phone applications, which is why TveeBoX is special.

“The TveeBoX is a perfect blend of low-cost computing/Internet access terminal as well as high-end digital media adaptor and social media on

TV platform. Imagine receiving your Facebook updates whilst watching your favourite TV programme, or making/receiving video calls on your CRT/high-definition TV, or connecting to a hosted cloud PC service. That is the power this device gives in your hand,” says Vishal Borker, CEO and technical director, NextBit Computing.

But how did NextBit achieve such high levels of convergence? This convergence was possible due to integration of various applications and the ORB platform.

“We have developed both the server side as well as set-top box side applications and middleware, which makes this kind of convergence possible. Further, a lot of these features are built into our ORB platform, which is also licensable as a software core (pretty much like Android) to other

The use of Linux operating system and GNU tools helps keep the software costs in check. As a result, a basic media adaptor STB with cloud PC interface costs around \$160